

SCIENCE TRICKS TO INCREASE YOUR GEEK CRED

51 Make magnetic slime/putty

You've probably watched a lot of videos where grey slime creepily comes to life whenever a magnet is brought near it. There's no magic here but the slime itself is magnetic hence it's attracted to the magnet. You can actually make magnetic slime with simple ingredients in the comfort of your home. You'll need liquid starch, black Iron Oxide powder, white glue, water, and utensils to measure and mix the contents.

Pour in half a cup of glue and water each into a bowl and stir them up. Next, move on to mixing half a cup of the black Iron Oxide powder to the mixture. **Be careful to not breathe the powder in as it is very damaging to your lungs.** Make sure that there aren't any lumps inside, so don't stop stirring until it's a uniform paste. Measure half a cup of liquid starch and add it to the mixture. This



is where the entire mix will start getting gooey. As it becomes more slimy, take it off from your bowl and let it sit for around 10 minutes. The mixture will slowly turn darker over time. Then you can start off teasing the mixture with a Neodymium magnet and be amazed at how the slime comes alive.

52 Build a lava lamp

Lava lamps are cool. If you come across one, you would probably stop and get lost into the colourful blobs floating inside. Want one right beside your bed? Well, you can build one at home. Wash out a

regular transparent soda bottle with a cap on it. Fill three quarters of the bottle with vegetable oil and the remaining with water. Add a few drops of food colouring of your choice to an extent where the liquid stops looking too



transparent. To emulate the fizzing, you can either use regular table salt or an effervescent tablet. Salt only lasts for a few seconds but if you break up an effervescent tablet and drop them in, the fizz stays longer. Effervescent tablets are made of Vitamin C so, any Vitamin C tablet would do. Make sure you break them up to have more fizz.

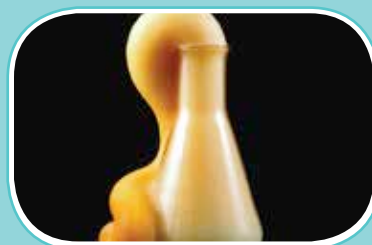
As soon as you drop the tablets, close the cap, tilt the bottle a couple of times and watch the magic happen. If the fizz stops, then simply add more salt or tablets. Place the bottle on a light source or point a flashlight to the bottom of the bottle to complete the look.

You can also add a darker colour and also add some glitter or sparkles to give it a nebula-like look. Adding glow-in-the-dark paint instead of food colouring will make things much more interesting. This is just a temporary lava lamp, of course. If you want to build a permanent more traditional one, head over to <http://dgit.in/LavaLmp> and make one.

53 Make elephant toothpaste

As kids, we loved science experiments that either blew up or ended in some spectacular reaction. Actually, we also love them even now as adults.

An incredible amount of foam gushing out of a small container is certainly a spectacle which will be enjoyed by everyone, young or old. There are two methods to conduct this experiment – one can be done with household items, whereas the other requires some concentrated chemicals. We'll stick to the easier one. You'll need Hydrogen Peroxide (6 percent solution or 20-volume) which you might already have at home or you can buy from a local medical shop. The other items include dry yeast, warm water, liquid dish washing soap and food colouring of your choice. This is another experiment that will get messy, so we would advise you to use a small tub placed on top of newspapers to run the experiment in. Getting the right amount of hydrogen peroxide is crucial since it determines the amount of foam that will be produced in the reaction. You'll find it in different concentrations including 3 and 6 percent, and even 30 percent. 6 percent is easy to acquire from a drug store, so that's what we're going with. Mix warm water and 3 tablespoons of yeast, and make sure there are no lumps. Now, it's time to mix the liquids. Pour liquid dishwash-



ing soap, food colouring, and half a cup of hydrogen peroxide into a bottle with a narrow neck. Now, that you have the two mixtures ready, it's time to froth things up. Add the yeast mixture slowly into the bottle through a funnel and watch in amazement as foam oozes out of the bottle. You can try out different variations again by adding glow-in-the-dark paint or glitter into it, and even try out bottles of different shapes and sizes. This entire experiment is called elephant toothpaste